



CORRECTIONS OFFICER

JOB DESCRIPTION

Corrections, or correctional, officers supervise the activities of convicted offenders in a prison. They monitor inmates at all times, enforce regulations, and maintain order, which often means searching prisoners and their cells. Officers also watch out for those at risk of harm and supervise the movement of prisoners in the vicinity. With experience, they may train new recruits or oversee a part of the institution.



SALARY

Entry-level officer ★★★★★
Senior officer ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Increasing job opportunities due to rising prison populations • Work mainly in the public sector but private prisons operate in some countries alongside government facilities

CAREER PATHS

Prisons are usually run by national or state authorities. To become a corrections officer, you will need to be a citizen of the country in which you work. Once trained, and with experience, you can apply for more senior roles within the service, or use your skills in other related areas, such as counseling and rehabilitation.

TRAINEE To be accepted as a trainee, you will need to be at least 18 years of age and pass a number of physical and mental assessments. Basic training usually lasts for several weeks.

SPECIAL OFFICER Trains in various areas, such as drug and alcohol counseling, suicide prevention, health care, or physical education, with the aim of helping prisoners overcome their problems and adjust to life after prison.



▼ RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **POLICE OFFICER** *see pp. 240–241*
- ▶ **PROBATION OFFICER** *see pp. 244–245*
- ▶ **PSYCHOLOGIST** *see pp. 254–255*

CORRECTIONS OFFICER As well as running the prison community, you help rehabilitate prisoners and work toward providing them with new skills that will be useful in the future.